

Excel based Case Study

You are working for a **global consulting firm operating across the Middle East and the USA**.

The leadership team has requested a **quick analytical review** of employee allocation, project timelines, and workload risks using Excel.

You have been provided with an Excel workbook **“Strategy - Excel Assignment”** containing:

- Employee-level information
- Project-level timelines

Your objective is to **analyse the data using Excel and present accurate, well-structured outputs**.

Assessment Requirements

Please complete the analysis for the below pointers 1 to 9 directly in the excel. **The dataset required for your assignment is provided in the excel “Strategy - Excel Assignment”**

You may add helper columns or sheets if required.

1. Team Structure Analysis

Using the provided dataset, create a dynamic view of the employee base that allows analysis of the distribution of employees across different teams, managers, or employee types.

Your output should enable the reviewer to interactively filter and explore the data across different dimensions to understand team composition.

2. Long-Running Projects Identification

From the project dataset, identify all projects that have been running for more than three months.

The output should clearly highlight the projects meeting this condition along with the relevant supporting information.

3. Employee Cohort Filtering

Using the employee dataset, identify and filter employees based on their year of joining.

The solution should make it easy to view employees belonging to a particular joining year and quarterly view

4. Project Status Classification

Enhance the project dataset by introducing a new column titled “Project Status.”

Based on the available project data, classify each project into appropriate status categories such as:

- > In Progress
- > Completed

The classification logic should be formula derived from the information available in the dataset.

5. Project Delay Analysis

Determine the number of days each project has been delayed, based on the planned and actual timelines available in the dataset.

The output should clearly show the duration of delay for each project where applicable and for projects which are not delayed (in progress or completed) should have their current status reflected there (in progress/completed)

6. Employee–Project Mapping

Develop a view that maps each employee to all the projects they have worked on, including both:

- > Current projects
- > Past projects

The output should provide a comprehensive mapping of employees and their associated projects.

7. Concurrent Project Allocation

Identify employees who are working on more than two projects at the same time.

Your analysis should take into consideration the overlap in project timelines to determine whether multiple projects were being handled concurrently.

8. Workload and Burnout Analysis

Assume the following working conditions:

- Normal working hours for each employee is 40 hrs per week.

	Client hr per project	Break per day	Ad-hoc hrs per week
Analyst	5	1	0
Consultant	5	1	0
Lead consultant	3	1	2
Manager	4	1	2
Principal Consultant	2	1	2
Senior Analyst	2	1	2
Senior Consultant	2	1	2

- If the total weekly utilization of employee is less than 40 hours per week then it should be marked as under-utilized.
- If the total weekly utilization of employee is between 40 to 50 hours per week, then it should be marked as optimally utilized
- If the total weekly utilization of employee is more than 50 hours per week, then it should be marked as over-utilized / burnout.

Using the available project allocation data, determine how many employees are likely to be overallocated or at risk of burnout based on these constraints.

9. Strategic Initiative Tracking Template

As the organization moves into **2026**, leadership has outlined a strong focus on **practice-level capability building and strategic improvement initiatives**. Each consulting practice is expected to drive its own set

of initiatives aimed at strengthening internal capabilities, improving delivery efficiency, and building differentiated value for clients.

These initiatives may include activities such as:

- Developing **internal frameworks and methodologies**
- Creating **accelerators, reusable assets, and tools**
- Establishing **best practices and delivery standards**
- Enhancing **practice capabilities and knowledge repositories**
- Driving initiatives aligned to **practice-level KPIs and performance goals**

Given the number of initiatives expected across multiple practices, leadership requires a **structured mechanism to track progress, monitor milestones, and measure completion status**.

As part of the **Strategy & Transformation team**, you have been asked to design a **standardized Excel-based template** that can be used by all practices to track their strategic initiatives in a consistent and transparent manner.

The template should allow each practice to:

- Track **multiple initiatives**
- Break initiatives into **smaller executable milestones**
- Monitor **progress and completion status**
- Provide a **consolidated view of initiative progress at the practice level**

Your task is to design a **template structure in Excel** that enables practices to capture and monitor their initiatives effectively.

Requirements

The template should be able to capture the following fields:

- **Practice Name**
- **Initiative Name**
- **Milestone Name**
- **Milestone Status (Completed / Pending)**

The template should also automatically determine:

- **Initiative Status**
 - An initiative should be marked as **Completed only when all associated milestones are completed**.
- **Percentage of Milestones Completed** for each initiative.

Additionally, the template should provide a **summary view** displaying:

- **Total number of initiatives**
- **Number of completed initiatives**
- **Number of pending initiatives**
- **Overall completion percentage**

Submission Guidelines

- Complete the analysis in the provided Excel file
- Ensure formulas are readable and logically structured
- Focus on accuracy, clarity, and analytical thinking